

Flying without wings

VS-300

Where Connecticut

When 1939

People had long tried to build helicopters, but it was in 1939 that Russian-American aviator Igor Sikorsky made one that

could be kept under control. His *VS-300* featured a rotating part called a rotor attached to the helicopter's tail to stop it from spinning while in flight. This innovation still features on most helicopters.



Cars for all

Ford Model T

Where Michigan

When 1908

Ford Motor Company's Model-T went on sale in the US in 1908. It was the world's first affordable car, and more than 15 million of them were sold. Like the Model T, most cars today still run on gasoline, although more eco-friendly electric cars are growing in popularity.



Only black models were sold after 1914.

1900 TO PRESENT

Launching into space

V-2 rocket

Where Peenemünde, Germany

When 1944

German scientists invented the V-2 rocket in 1936. It was loaded with explosives and used against Germany's enemies during World War II. In 1944, a V-2 launched vertically and reached a height of 109 miles (175 km), entering space. After Germany's defeat in the war, V-2 technology was further developed by US and Soviet scientists, leading to the creation of space rockets.



Reusable spacecraft

Space Shuttle Columbia

Where Florida

When 1981

All early spacecraft could only complete one flight because they broke apart on reentering Earth's atmosphere. On April 12, 1981, the US launched its first reusable Space Shuttle, *Columbia*. Reusable spacecraft have allowed humans to establish a permanent presence in space aboard satellites such as the International Space Station.

The shuttle's cargo bay was used to carry supplies into space.

